INGLÉS · NIVEL A1 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Be or do/does? Questions and negatives in English A1

First locate the finite verb. If it is be, move or negate be. If it is a lexical verb in the present simple, use do or does and keep the main verb in its base form.

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Choose be, do or does accurately in statements, negatives, yes/no questions and WH questions.

MODELO

She is ready. Is she ready? / She works here. Does she work here?

Al terminar podrás

1. Distinguish be from lexical verbs
2. Build negatives with not or do not
3. Build yes/no and WH questions
4. Repair agreement and base-form errors

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve las seis etapas y corrige al final. Vuelve al modelo para justificar cada decisión.

WELEARN STUDY SEQUENCE

01	02	03	04
complete guide	exercise workbook	answer key	retrieval review

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

01 · COMPRENDER

La idea esencial

This lesson unifies the two basic English operator systems. Be moves and takes not itself; lexical verbs use do or does while the main verb returns to the base form. The comparison prevents errors such as Do you are⋯? and She not works.

Run the one-question diagnosis

The surface order depends on the verb system, not on whether the Spanish translation contains ser or estar. Find the English finite verb first.

If the finite verb is am, is or are, use it as the operator. Every other present-simple verb normally needs do or does for questions and negatives.

Verb system	Question	Negative
be	Is she ready?	She is not ready.
lexical verb	Does she work?	She does not work.

Move be; do not add do

Be can move before the subject because it already carries tense and agreement. Is Nora here? Are they ready?

Adding do creates two competing operators. Do you are ready is impossible in the standard A1 system.

Statement	Question
You are ready.	Are you ready?
Nora is here.	Is Nora here?
They are late.	Are they late?

Use do or does with lexical verbs

A lexical verb does not move to the front in an A1 present-simple question. Do or does carries tense and agreement instead.

Use does with he, she and it. Use do with I, you, we and they.

Subject	Operator	Example
I/you/we/they	do	Do they work?
he/she/it	does	Does she work?

Return to the base form after does

The -s belongs to the operator does, so the main verb cannot keep another -s. Does he work is correct.

The same principle applies in negatives: he does not work, not he does not works.

Avoid	Use
Does she likes⋯?	Does she like⋯?
He doesn’t drives.	He doesn’t drive.

Build WH questions on the same frame

A WH word adds an information slot but does not change the operator system. Where is she? uses be; Where does she work? uses does.

Who can sometimes be the subject and then needs no do: Who works here? At A1, learn this as a controlled contrast.

Target	Frame	Example
place + be	WH + be + S	Where is Nora?
place + lexical	WH + do/does + S + V	Where does Nora work?
subject	Who + V	Who works here?

Keep short answers parallel

A short answer repeats the operator, not the lexical verb. Is she ready? Yes, she is. Does she work? Yes, she does.

This parallelism is a useful final check: if the short-answer operator sounds wrong, recheck the question frame.

Question	Positive	Negative
Are they ready?	Yes, they are.	No, they aren't.
Do they work?	Yes, they do.	No, they don't.

Control contractions and register

Contractions are normal in conversation and neutral writing: isn't, aren't, don't and doesn't. Full forms create more emphasis or formality.

Do not contract positive short answers: Yes, she's is not the standard answer to Is she ready? Use Yes, she is.

Full	Contracted
is not	isn't
are not	aren't
do not	don't
does not	doesn't

Audit the complete sentence

Check operator, subject, lexical verb and complement in that order. Then verify whether agreement appears only once.

Reading the full question with its short answer exposes most A1 errors immediately.

Check	Question
operator	be or do/does?
agreement	where is the -s?
main verb	base form after does?
answer	same operator repeated?

From controlled form to real A1 communication

A learner controls Be or do/does? only when the form survives outside a single model sentence. Begin with the central contrast, rebuild it with a new subject and new vocabulary, and then place it inside a short exchange. The structure should remain accurate while the communicative details change.

Use a three-part review. First, name the intended meaning. Second, point to the word or position that carries that meaning. Third, read the whole sentence and check whether reference, agreement and register still fit the situation. This review turns a correct answer into a reusable A1 skill.

Do not judge the target form in isolation. Read the words immediately before and after it, identify the subject and the finite verb, and reconstruct the positive or neutral sentence when useful. This local context often explains an ending, an auxiliary, a determiner or a position that would otherwise seem arbitrary.

For independent study, complete one short stage at a time and record the reason for every correction. A useful note has three parts: the form you wrote, the form the sentence requires and the decision that separates them. Revisit that decision with a new example within twenty-four hours, then read both examples aloud and compare their rhythm with confidence.

Stage	Action	Success evidence
Recognise	identify the target decision	explains the meaning
Rebuild	change subject or vocabulary	keeps the pattern
Use	place it in a mini-dialogue	sounds complete
Review	correct and explain	names the controlling rule

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

identify the verb -> choose be or do/does -> place subject -> keep the correct main-verb form

Decide en este orden

1. Locate the finite verb.
2. Ask whether the verb is be.
3. Choose am/is/are for be.
4. Choose do/does for a lexical verb.
5. Return the lexical verb to the base form after does.
6. Place the subject after the operator in a question.
7. Place not after the operator in a negative.
8. Check short answers with the same operator.

Decision	Pattern	Example
Be question	Are	Are you ready?
Lexical question	Do	Do you work here?
Third-person question	Does	Does Lina live here?
Base form	speak	Does Amir speak English?
Be negative	is not	Nora is not tired.
Lexical negative	does not drink	Nora does not drink coffee.
Plural be	are not	They are not at home.
Plural lexical	do not work	They do not work on Sundays.
WH + be	is	Where is Amir?

Errores frecuentes

× Do you are ready? -> Are you ready?

× She not works. -> She does not work.

× Does he studies? -> Does he study?

× They do not are here. -> They are not here.

× Where does she is? -> Where is she?

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

Are you ready?	Be moves before you.
Do you work here?	Work uses do with you.
Does Lina live here?	Lina uses does.
Does Amir speak English?	After does, use the base form.
Nora is not tired.	Be takes not directly.
Nora does not drink coffee.	Does carries agreement.
They are not at home.	They uses are.
They do not work on Sundays.	They uses do not + base.

03 · PRÁCTICA

De reconocer a producir

24 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

A · Recognise the pattern

1. ___ you ready? Opciones: Are · Do · Does · Is

2. ___ you work here? Opciones: Do · Are · Is · Does

3. ___ Lina live here? Opciones: Does · Is · Do · Has

4. Does Amir ___ English? Opciones: speak · speaks · speaking · is speak

5. Nora ___ tired. Opciones: is not · does not · not is · do not

6. Nora ___ coffee. Opciones: does not drink · is not drink · does not drinks · not drinks

7. They ___ at home. Opciones: are not · do not · is not · not are

8. They ___ on Sundays. Opciones: do not work · are not work · does not work · not works

9. Where ___ Amir? Opciones: is · does · do · are

10. Where ___ Amir work? Opciones: does · is · do · are

11. Is she ready? Yes, she ___. Opciones: is · does · do · ready

12. Does she drive? No, she ___. Opciones: does not · is not · do not · drives not

B · Connect two decisions

13. _____ you ready? _____ you work here? Opciones: Are · Do · Does · Is / Do · Are · Is · Does

14. _____ Lina live here? Does Amir _____ English? Opciones: Does · Is · Do · Has / speak · speaks · speaking · is speak

15. Nora _____ tired. Nora _____ coffee. Opciones: is not · does not · not is · do not / does not drink · is not drink · does not drinks · not drinks

16. They _____ at home. They _____ on Sundays. Opciones: are not · do not · is not · not are / do not work · are not work · does not work · not works

17. Where _____ Amir? Where _____ Amir work? Opciones: is · does · do · are / does · is · do · are

C · Read a connected text

18. _____ you ready? _____ you work here? _____ Lina live here? Does Amir _____ English? Nora _____ tired. Nora _____ coffee. They _____ at home. They _____ on Sundays.

D · Retrieve without options

19. They _____ at home. They _____ on Sundays. Where _____ Amir? Where _____ Amir work? Is she ready? Yes, she _____. Does she drive? No, she _____.

E · Produce in context

20. Write two be questions and two lexical-verb questions about a class.

_____

21. Write one be negative and two present-simple negatives.

_____

22. Write a four-line interview using a question and a short answer from each system.

_____

F · Final mission

23. Write an 80-110 word interview with a new classmate. Include three be questions, three do/does questions, two negatives, two WH questions and four short answers.

_____

24. Choose two sentences from your mission. For each one, name the Be or do/does? decision and explain why the selected form fits.

_____

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. Are — Be moves before you.
2. Do — Work uses do with you.
3. Does — Lina uses does.
4. speak — After does, use the base form.
5. is not — Be takes not directly.
6. does not drink — Does carries agreement.
7. are not — They uses are.
8. do not work — They uses do not + base.
9. is — Where precedes is + subject.
10. does — Work needs does.
11. is — Repeat be in the short answer.
12. does not — Repeat does in the short answer.
13. Are / Do — Be moves before you. Work uses do with you.
14. Does / speak — Lina uses does. After does, use the base form.
15. is not / does not drink — Be takes not directly. Does carries agreement.
16. are not / do not work — They uses are. They uses do not + base.
17. is / does — Where precedes is + subject. Work needs does.
18. Are / Do / Does / speak / is not / does not drink / are not / do not work — Be moves before you. Work uses do with you. Lina uses does. After does, use the base form. Be takes not directly. Does carries agreement. They uses are. They uses do not + base.
19. are not / do not work / is / does / is / does not — They uses are. They uses do not + base. Where precedes is + subject. Work needs does. Repeat be in the short answer. Repeat does in the short answer.
20. Is the class difficult? Are the students ready? Do they study every day? Does the teacher give homework? — Each question uses the correct operator.
21. The room is not cold. Nora does not work on Fridays. We do not study at night. — Not follows the correct operator.
22. Are you a student? Yes, I am. Do you work after class? No, I do not. — The short answers repeat the operator.
23. Are you new in this class? Yes, I am. Is your name Lina? No, it is not; my name is Nora. Where are you from? I am from Colombia. Do you live near the school? Yes, I do. Does your brother study here too? No, he does not. What does he do? He works in a café. Are your classes in the morning? Yes, they are. Do you take the bus every day? No, I do not. I usually walk because my apartment is close. — The interview alternates the two operator systems consistently.
24. Are you ready? Be moves before you. Do you work here? Work uses do with you. — The audit makes the learner connect a produced form with its controlling decision.

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.

Retrieval

Review focus	Retrieval	Feedback
Distinguish be from lexical verbs	Explain and exemplify: Distinguish be from lexical verbs.	Locate the finite verb.
Build negatives with not or do not	Explain and exemplify: Build negatives with not or do not.	Ask whether the verb is be.
Build yes/no and WH questions	Explain and exemplify: Build yes/no and WH questions.	Choose am/is/are for be.

Review focus	Retrieval	Feedback
Repair agreement and base-form errors	Explain and exemplify: Repair agreement and base-form errors.	Choose do/does for a lexical verb.